

While health insurance largely focuses on the acute, someone on the path to FI has incredible built-in advantages when it comes to preventative and maintenance health care because we create bandwidth or space in our lives. The reduction or removal of many stressors allows us to have more time to focus on living healthier lives now, including more time to make home-cooked meals, exercise, and participate in a community.

Let me put my pharmacist jacket on: Blue Cross Blue Shield did a study that found that ten conditions are responsible for 58 percent of all reductions in health. Of that list, the top conditions are associated with lifestyle factors heavily affected by diet, exercise, and stress. Most notably, they are diabetes, hypertension, high cholesterol, and coronary artery disease.

So many people sacrifice their health for their jobs or careers, and it can be difficult to unwind thirty to fifty years of this choice.

In my original career, I was a physical therapist. I've always understood the importance of living a healthy lifestyle. I made a conscious effort to be physically active, eat reasonably well, control stress, and get good sleep.